HIGH-SPEED TRAVEL

Running at a maximum speed of 320kmph, the bullet train will significantly reduce the travel time between Ahmedabad and Mumbai

BULLET TRAIN
2.07 hrs (two stops)
2.58 hrs (all 10 stops)



AIRPLANE
3.10 hrs (including the 2-hour check-in time)



RAIL
5-7 hrs



CAR
8 hrs



BUS
9.30 hrs





"THE IMPACT OF THIS HIGH-SPEED RAIL NETWORK GOES BEYOND JUST CONNECTING PHYSICAL LOCATIONS. IT TIES DIFFERENT ECONOMIC HUBS TOGETHER, FOSTERING COLLABORATION AND GROWTH"

ASHWINI VAISHNAW
Union Minister for Railways

tion Act, which worked out to four times the market rate in rural areas and twice the market rate in urban areas. In Surat, Jayesh Patel, who led a successful movement for higher compensation, claims that though "50 per cent of the farmers are happy" and have used the money to construct a new house or buy a car or another piece of land to continue farming, "an equal number are still dissatisfied".

Since the bullet train's route must be straight, varying portions of farms were acquired for the project. "An elevated viaduct has minimised the need for land acquisition besides reducing the overall environmental impact of the project," says an NHSRCL spokesperson. While 951.14 hectares have been acquired in Gujarat, 430.45 ha have been acquired in Maharashtra and 7.9 ha in Dadra & Nagar Haveli. Officials claim that in many places, farmers have resumed agricultural activities even after receiving compensation once the elevated viaduct was constructed.

INDUSTRIAL CLUSTERS

Even as the government sorts out such pending issues surrounding the acquisition process, an array of high-profile industrial clusters has been planned in Gujarat to maximise the economic benefits of the MAHSR corridor. For instance, the bullet train is a key sales point of GIFT City (Gujarat Industrial Finance Tec-City) in Gandhinagar, which is being projected as a greenfield extension of Mumbai. Located 23 km from the Sabarmati HSR station, it is well connected to it by road and Metro rail.

Sanand, about a 45-minute drive from the station, is being developed as an automobile, semiconductor and space manufacturing hub. The city is home to India's first plug and play industrial park, which has come up after collaboration with the Japan External Trade Organisation in 2022. Tata Motors, which opened its Nano plant in Sanand in 2009, has last year also acquired the Ford Motors plant that had come up in 2011. MG Motors' singular manufacturing facility is 150 km away in Halol, while Honda and Maruti Suzuki's manufacturing plants in the Mandal-Becharaji SEZ are just 64 km away. The US chipmaker Micron Technology has already been assigned land in Sanand for its maiden manufacturing facility in India with an investment of $2.75 billion (Rs 22,875 crore). In October 2023, the Gujarat government also signed an MoU with IN-SPACe—an autonomous entity under the GoI's space department—to develop a space manufacturing cluster in the region.

Moving south, Agate Stone Industries Cluster is coming up in Anand. The unique hard stones are found in Khambhat. The unorganised industry expects to exploit a bigger market by streamlining technical support and access to buyers. In addition to the chemical processing industries in Jhagadia and Ankleshwar, central Gujarat is poised to emerge as a pharmaceutical hub with a massive 2,000-acre bulk drug park in Jambusar. The park is expected to draw an investment of Rs 8,000 crore and house about 400 companies, focused on manufacturing key starting materials (KSMs) and active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) to reduce dependence on imports.

Surat is already a hub of diamond polishing and trading. Inaugurated in December 2023, the Surat Diamond Bourse is spread over 6.7 million sq. feet and pegged as the world's largest office space. It is strategically located just 25 km from the bullet train station at Kadodara with express road connectivity. A food processing cluster is also in the works at Navsari, barely 33 km from Kadodara.

In Vadodara, the European avia-